

Confined Space

OSHA Confined Space Definition:

1. Is large enough and so configured that an employee can bodily enter and perform assigned work; and
2. Has limited or restricted means for entry and exit; and
3. Is NOT designed for continuous human occupancy.

OSHA Confined Space Definition:

1. Is large enough and so configured that an employee can bodily enter and perform assigned work?

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1. Is big enough to get inside the space and do your work; and

1. Is the space big enough to get into the space to do your work?



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OSHA Confined Space Definition:

2. Has limited or restricted means for entry or exit.

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2. Is the space difficult to get in or out of?

Criterion 2: Limited or Restricted Entry / Exit

A space FAILS this criterion (is NOT restricted) only when BOTH conditions below are true:

1

Walk in upright and unimpeded

No raised threshold to step over, no low header to duck under, no narrow opening to squeeze through.

2

Clear path back to the exit

Equipment or layout inside doesn't block your travel path — you can turn around and walk straight out.

If EITHER condition is false — a threshold, a stoop, a squeeze, or a blocked path — the space DOES meet Criterion 2.

EXAMPLE



Walk-in switchgear room

Full-height door, flat threshold, clear aisle to the exit. → Criterion 2 FAILS — not restricted.



Below-grade pump vault

Raised hatch curb to step over, low pipe rack to duck under, equipment blocking the path to the ladder. → Criterion 2 MET — restricted.

Is the space difficult to get in or out of?



Is the space difficult to get in or out of?



Is the space difficult to get in or out of?



Is the space difficult to get in or out of?



OSHA Confined Space Definition:

3. Is not designed for continuous human occupancy.

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3. Was the space NOT designed for people to be in it for long periods of time?

Was the space NOT designed for people to be in it for long periods of time?



Yes, this space may not be small,



Was the space NOT designed for people to be in it for long periods of time?



So yes, this one is not intended for human occupancy.



Was the space NOT designed for people to be in it for long periods of time?



Confined Space Questions:

1. Is the space big enough that you can actually get inside the space to do your work?
2. Is the space difficult to move in or out of?
3. Is the space NOT designed for people to be in for long amounts of time?



to be in for long amounts of time?



IS THIS A CONFINED SPACE?



1. Is the space big enough that you can actually get inside the space to do your work?
2. Is the space difficult to move in or out of?
3. Is the space NOT designed for people to be in for long amounts of time?

IS THIS A CONFINED SPACE?



1. Is the space big enough that you can actually get inside the space to do your work?



2. Is the space difficult to move in or out of?



3. Is the space NOT designed for people to be in for long amounts of time?

IS THIS A CONFINED SPACE?



✓
✗ = NOT A
✓ CONFINED
SPACE



IS THIS A CONFINED SPACE?



1. Is the space big enough that you can actually get inside the space to do your work?
2. Is the space difficult to move in or out of?
3. Is the space NOT designed for people to be in for long amounts of time?



IS THIS A CONFINED SPACE?



1. Is the space big enough that you can actually get inside the space to do your work?



2. Is the space difficult to move in or out of?



3. Is the space NOT designed for people to be in for long amounts of time?



IS THIS A CONFINED SPACE?



✗

✓

✓

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**NOT A
CONFINED
SPACE**



IS THIS A CONFINED SPACE?



1. Is the space big enough that you can actually get inside the space to do your work?
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3. Is the space NOT designed for people to be in for long amounts of time?



IS THIS A CONFINED SPACE?



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**CONFINED
SPACE**

